Prime Minister's speech nor with the data in Economic Survey (different period and different type of tax payers).'

This was a weak argument, given that media headlines on 17 May 2017 proclaimed that these were numbers post-demonetization, which was not clarified by the Ministry at that time. More importantly, the Economic Survey states that the total number of tax payers for the entire financial year 2016–17 as 80.7 lakh, not 91 lakh.

- 33 lakh in Rajya Sabha:[35] 'The reply to Unstarred Question No. 2017 in Rajya Sabha on 01.08.2017 mentioned that during 09.11.2016 to 31.03.2017 the number of ITR (income tax returns) filed was 1.96 crore as against 1.63 crore filed during the corresponding period of last financial year (2015–16). Therefore, the number of additional returns filed during this period works out to be 33 lakh. However, this data cannot be compared with the other data mentioned above. The data referred to in Economic Survey is with regard to new tax payers or first-time return filers only whereas the data provided in the Rajya Sabha Question was in respect of all returns filed.'
- 5.4 lakh in Economic Survey: 'The analysis given in Table-6 on page 22 of the Economic Survey (Vol.2) is based on the data for the period of 9 November to 31 March of 2016–17 and corresponding periods of the last two financial years. Moreover, the growth in the number of tax payers discussed in the Economic Survey is based on the number of new tax payers assuming the previous year's growth rate as the reference growth rate. On the other hand, the growth of Individual return-filers referred to in Prime Minister's speech is with respect to new as well as old tax payers. Thus, the data used in Economic Survey is different from data referred to in Prime Minister's speech in respect of the period of filing as well as the type of tax payers and the two are not comparable.'